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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Junior Legal Secretary role at the property firm represented by Birchrose Associates. Property work is an area I have direct exposure to through my placement at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, and the secretarial and administrative support function described is one I have practised in a live legal environment.

At BCLP I spent six months in the Real Estate Disputes team, where I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with court filings, maintained matter records on iManage, and tracked deadlines across several concurrent matters. That experience gave me a clear understanding of what fee earners need from strong support staff: accurate document management, reliable deadline tracking, and the ability to handle a high volume of work without letting things slip. I also drafted client notes and helped open and close matters, so the administrative rhythm of a property team is familiar to me.

Alongside that, I have been working as a Legal Adviser at Citizens Advice East Berkshire since July 2026, managing matters from initial client interview through to submission. I draft correspondence, prepare document schedules, and maintain confidential case records independently. Keeping files organised and submissions on time is a core part of that role, and I carry that same discipline into any support or administrative context.

I am drawn to this role because property is a practice area I already have some grounding in, and a junior secretary position within a busy team is a practical next step that would let me develop that further while contributing immediately. Working within a dedicated property team, rather than across a general caseload, would also deepen my understanding of conveyancing and property transactions in a way my disputes experience alone has not.

I am available at short notice and happy to discuss the role further.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva